

Impact of Technology: Social Worksheet

Grade 8 • Worksheet • About 25 minutes

Work with pen and paper. Use color pencils if you like. You do not need a computer or the internet.

Name: _____

Grade/Section: _____

Date: _____

How to use this worksheet

- Do the parts **in order** from top to bottom.
- Each part has a **time** so you know how long to spend.
- Read every instruction before you write. You can do this on your own.

Part 1 – What you will learn (about 3 minutes)

What you will learn: Social impact means how technology changes **relationships**, **access** to opportunities, **jobs**, and **well-being**. In this worksheet you will learn about the **digital divide**, healthy **boundaries** online, **ethics** when sharing, and actions you can take in your community.

Do this:

1. **In one sentence**, what is social impact of technology?

2. **Name one way** technology changed how you talk to friends or family (e.g. group chat, video call, social feed).

Part 2 – Who benefits and who is left out (about 5 minutes)

The **digital divide** means unequal access to devices, reliable internet, or digital skills. When homework, jobs, or services move online, people without access can be left behind—even when the change helps others.

Real-life scenario: A town adds free Wi-Fi downtown but not in rural neighborhoods. Teachers assign homework that must be submitted online.

Discuss with a partner or reflect in writing: Who likely gains? Who might struggle?

Do this:

Group	Likely benefit or barrier (write one)
Students with home internet	
Students in rural areas with weak signal	
Families who share one phone	
Local businesses downtown	

Critical thinking: Write one fair policy the town or school could try so more students can complete online work (e.g. library hours, loaner devices, offline alternatives).

Part 3 – Communication and well-being (about 5 minutes)

Technology can connect people, but it can also create **pressure** (comparison, fear of missing out) or hurt feelings. **Boundaries** are limits you set—for example, no messages after a certain time, or asking before sharing someone’s photo.

Real-life scenario: A group chat gets busy at night. One student sees memes that seem to make fun of them. They feel excluded and cannot sleep well.

Discuss with a partner or reflect in writing: How could group **rules** help without banning all technology?

Do this: Write 2 group norms (rules) that could help this chat. For each norm, circle what it mainly protects: **privacy**, **kindness**, or **rest**.

1. Norm:

Protects: *privacy* / *kindness* / *rest* (circle one)

2. Norm:

Protects: *privacy* / *kindness* / *rest* (circle one)

Part 4 – Ethics and responsibility (about 5 minutes)

Consent means getting permission before you share someone’s photo, video, or personal story.

Privacy means respecting what others want to keep to themselves. **Respect** online is the same idea as respect in person: treat others the way you would want to be treated.

Real-life scenario: A friend posts a photo of you at a party without asking. The post gets many comments and shares. You feel embarrassed.

Do this:

1. **List 2 respectful actions** the friend could have taken instead.

1.

2.

2. **List 2 respectful actions** you could take now (not revenge—solutions).

1.

2.

Discuss with a partner or reflect in writing: Is “everyone does it” a good reason to post photos of others without asking? **In one sentence**, explain your view.

Part 5 – Personal and community action (about 5 minutes)

You can influence how technology is used around you. Small, steady actions often work better than trying to change everything at once.

Do this: Design a **digital impact pledge**—three actions you are willing to try (examples: ask before posting, balance screen time, speak up about mean comments, help a classmate with tech trouble).

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Critical thinking:

- **Which pledge will be hardest for you? Why?**

- **In one sentence**, how could adults or your school **support** healthy technology use without controlling every choice?

Part 6 – Check what you learned (about 2 minutes)

Checklist. Put a ✓ in the box when it is true for you.

- ☐ I know what social impact of technology means.
- ☐ I understand the digital divide and who may be left out.
- ☐ I understand boundaries and well-being in online communication.
- ☐ I understand consent, privacy, and respect when sharing online.
- ☐ I have thought about personal actions and community support.

When all boxes are checked, you have reviewed the main ideas from this worksheet.